

ENG501 SHORT HANDOUTS

NOTES FINAL TERM

Lesson 31 to 45

(ENG501) History of English Language

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Lesson 31

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STANDARDIZATION OF ENGLISH IN THE 19TH AND 20TH CENTURY

Topic 151: New Words in Modern English

What contributed to the immense increase in vocabulary items in the 19th and 20th century?

Scientists drew on various sources to form new vocabulary.

Give examples of words created by giving scientific meanings to existing ones.

Salt (chemistry), fruit and pollen (botany), parasite (zoology).

How were words borrowed from other languages to expand English vocabulary?

Latin (bacillus, corolla), Greek (acne, eczema), German (cobalt, paraffin), and names of European scientists.

What is a common way to create new words using Greek and Latin material?

Inventing them, e.g., biosphere, haemoglobin.

Explain the process of shortening words.

Shortened words often start as colloquial and may involve cutting off the beginning or ending.

What is blending, and give examples of portmanteau words.

Blending combines words, e.g., brunch (breakfast + lunch); portmanteau words include slithy and mimsy.

Topic 152: Standardization of Spelling & Changes in Pronunciation

How did printing contribute to the standardization of spelling?

Printing introduced widely accepted conventions, leading to standardized spelling in printed books.

What were some differences in spelling between Addison's punctuation and modern standards?

Minor differences like carry'd and publick.

Explain the changes in pronunciation during the Late Modern Period.

/r/ disappeared before consonants and a pause; pronunciation of certain words changed.

What is a spelling pronunciation, and how does it arise?

Spelling pronunciation occurs when people learn words from print and may mispronounce them based on their spelling.

Topic 153: Slang in the 19th and 20th Centuries

Define slang according to Webster in 1828.

"Low, vulgar, unmeaning language."

How did the definition of slang evolve according to the Oxford Dictionary (1911)?

Language of a highly colloquial type, below the level of standard educated speech, consisting of new or current words with special senses.

Provide examples of words that were once slang.

Boom, slump, crank, fad.

What role does slang play in language today?

Slang expresses a desire for freshness and novelty; it is more prevalent and influential than in the past.

Topic 154: Issues of Register and Accent

What accent has been accepted as a standard in England for over a century?

RP (Received Pronunciation).

How has the prestige of accents changed in recent times?

RP has lost some prestige; regional accents, especially "soft" accents, are more acceptable in many contexts.

Topic 155: British and Irish English

When did English rule extend over the entire island of Ireland?

16th–17th century.

How did Irish English originate?

In 1169 with competition between English, French, and Irish.

What impact did the loss of French have on the status of Irish and English in Ireland?

Enhanced the status of Irish until the 17th century.

Describe a distinctive feature of Irish English pronunciation.

Use of spellings like tay (tea) and the influence of the Irish prepositional system.

How does Irish English differ syntactically from other dialects?

Irish dialects make more use of do-periphrasis, e.g., "They does be lonesome by night."

Lesson 32

19TH AND 20TH CENTURY ENGLISH: TENDENCIES

Topic 156: English Worldwide

What is the current status of English worldwide?

Answer: English is no longer exclusive to the British; it has global prevalence with variations in former British Empire regions like the United States, Australia, Africa, South Asia, and Canada.

Topic 157: Pidgins and Creoles

Define a pidgin and provide an example.

Answer: A pidgin is a simplified language used for trade between groups with no common language. Example: Tok Pisin in Papua New Guinea.

When does a pidgin become a creole?

Answer: When a pidgin becomes the first language of a group, it transforms into a creole.

Topic 158: The Oxford English Dictionary

Why was The Oxford English Dictionary (OED) initiated?

Answer: The inadequacy of existing dictionaries led to the formation of a committee in 1857 to create a comprehensive dictionary, recording words from around 1000 AD.

What were the two principal aims of The Oxford English Dictionary project?

Answer: To record every English word since 1000 AD and exhibit the history of each word's forms, spellings, uses, and meanings.

Topic 159: Grammatical Tendencies - Verb-Adverb Combinations

Explain the development of the get passive in the 19th century.

Answer: The get passive (e.g., 'he got hurt') emerged in the 19th century for dynamic expression compared to 'he is hurt' or 'he became hurt.'

What is a significant tendency related to verb-adverb combinations in modern English?

Answer: The extension of verb-adverb combinations, often one-syllable verbs with adverbs, shows figurative and idiomatic usage.

Topic 160: Summary of Characteristics of the 19th and 20th Century English

How did the 19th and 20th centuries view linguistic questions differently?

Answer: They adopted a more enlightened and tolerant approach, accepting colloquial and regional forms.

What were the main influences on vocabulary changes during the 19th and 20th centuries?

Answer: Changes were driven by the influence of science, media, and technology, while grammar remained relatively stable.

What is the overall characteristic of 19th and 20th-century English?

Answer: English exhibited worldwide spread, with a call for knowledge coupled with tolerance, especially regarding usage.

Lesson-33

EXPANSION OF THE GENERAL VOCABULARY IN TODAY'S ENGLISH

Topic 161: Reasons for Expansion of Vocabulary Today

What are the methods involved in the expansion of vocabulary?

Answer: Coining, borrowing, root borrowing, new meanings, blending, and chopping off.

Name some reasons for the expansion of vocabulary.

Answer: Changing times, need of the times, inventions, technology, science, traveling, communication, and media.

Topic 162: Expansion of Vocabulary: Loan Words

What is the primary source of vocabulary expansion discussed in this topic?

Answer: Borrowing, mainly loan words, with a focus on Latin.

Apart from Latin, which language has significantly contributed to loan words in English?

Answer: French, with examples such as bayonet, anatomy, and docility.

Topic 163: Expansion of Vocabulary: Affixation

What is the most common method of word-formation discussed in affixation?

Answer: Affixation, involving the use of prefixes and suffixes.

How does affixation contribute to the flexibility of the English language?

Answer: Affixation allows the creation of new words, altering meanings and forming different parts of speech.

Topic 164: Expansion of Vocabulary: Compounding

What is compounding in word-formation?

Answer: Compounding involves combining two or more free morphemes to form words, such as 'airport' or 'seashore.'

Provide examples of blended words formed through compounding.

Answer: Motel (motor + hotel), smog (smoke + fog), chocoholic (chocolate + alcoholic), earworm, staycation, webisode, crowdfunding, and handover.

Topic 165: Expansion of Vocabulary: Conversion

Define conversion in the context of word-formation.

Answer: Conversion is the process by which a word belonging to one word class is transferred to another word class without a change in form.

Name some major types of conversion.

Answer: Noun to verb, verb to noun, adjective to noun, and adjective to verb.

Lesson-34

ENGLISH AS WORLD LANGUAGE

Topic 166: Status of English in Today's World

How does the status of English in the world today compare to the past?

Answer: English, once limited to a few million speakers in England, has now become one of the major world languages with over 400 million native speakers and many more using it as a second or foreign language.

In which regions did English-language speakers outnumber the original inhabitants, and what were the consequences?

Answer: In North America, Australia, and New Zealand, English speakers outnumbered and dominated the native inhabitants (Native Americans, Australian Aborigines, Maoris), leading to little influence of native languages.

Topic 167: Number of Speakers of English Today

How is the popularity and importance of a language measured?

Answer: The number of speakers, including those using English as their first, second, or foreign language.

What is the estimated number of second-language speakers of English compared to first-language speakers?

Answer: Second-language speakers of English are expected to soon exceed first-language speakers, reaching a situation without precedent for an international language.

Topic 168: English as a Mother Tongue

Which countries have English as a first language?

Answer: USA, Canada, Britain, Ireland, Australia, New Zealand, South Africa, several Caribbean countries, and other territories.

How does English rank globally among mother tongues?

Answer: English is the second or third most popular mother tongue globally, with an estimated 350-400 million native speakers.

Topic 169: English as a Lingua Franca

What is a lingua franca, and when did the concept emerge strongly?

Answer: A lingua franca is a common language between speakers of different native languages. The concept gained strength in the 20th century, especially since the 1950s.

Where does English serve as a lingua franca, and what role does it play?

Answer: English serves as a lingua franca in Europe and former Anglophone colonies, facilitating communication between speakers with different native languages.

Topic 170: Divergent Development in Modern English

What factors have contributed to controversies about the English language in former British colonies?

Answer: Factors include nationalist sentiments, attachment to traditional culture, desires for advances in science and technology, and conflicting needs for local and international communication.

How do outer-circle varieties of English differ phonologically from RP and General American?

Answer: Outer-circle varieties often have reduced phonemic systems, with differences in the realization and distribution of phonemes. For example, some Nigerian English has only one phoneme for both /ɪ/ and /i:/, resulting in bid and bead being pronounced as /bid/.

In what ways does American English differ from British English in terms of grammar?

Answer: Differences include past tenses of verbs (dove, fit, snuck vs. dived, fitted, sneaked) and usage patterns (do have vs. have got).

Which aspect of English shows the greatest divergences among different varieties?

Answer: Vocabulary exhibits the greatest divergences among different varieties of English as a first language, especially due to the expansion of English across continents.

Lesson-35

INTRODUCTION TO AMERICAN ENGLISH

Topic 171: English in America & its Features

What are some common names used to refer to American English?

Answer: American English is sometimes referred to as United States English, U.S. English, or by abbreviations like AME, AE, AmEng, USEng, en-US.

What is the historical background of English in the United States?

Answer: English in the United States is a result of British colonization during the 17th century, followed by migrations in the 18th and 19th centuries. American English has developed into various dialects influenced by West African and Native American languages, as well as languages of immigrants.

Topic 172: American Dialects: Linguistic Variety and Uniformity in America

What are some examples of cultural and ethnic American English varieties?

Answer: African American Vernacular (Ebonics), Cajun Vernacular, Hawaiian Pidgin, Latino Vernacular Englishes (including Chicano English, Miami English, Pennsylvania Dutch English, Yeshiva English).

How does William Labov describe "General American English"?

Answer: Labov describes General American English as a fairly uniform broadcast standard in mass media, but this standard is not uniformly adopted across all regional accents in the United States.

Topic 173: American English Pronunciation

What is the characteristic feature of rhoticity in General American English?

Answer: General American accents are firmly rhotic, pronouncing the 'r' sound in all environments, including after vowels (e.g., pearl, car, court).

What is the "Wine-Whine Merger" in General American English?

Answer: In General American English, the consonants spelled 'w' and 'wh' are usually pronounced the same. The separate phoneme /ʍ/ (wh) is present only in certain dialects.

Topic 174: American English Grammar

How do collective nouns function in American English grammar?

Answer: Collective nouns in American English are treated as singular, for example, "The band is good."

What are some grammatical differences between American English and British English in terms of auxiliary verbs?

Answer: Americans use "I will go home now," while the British might say "I shall go home now." In questions, a British person might say "Shall we go now?" whereas an American might say "Should we go now?"

Topic 175: American English Vocabulary

Why have linguistic differences between British and American English decreased over the last century?

Answer: Increasing similarity is attributed to better communication systems and the impact of American culture through mediums like television and film.

How did North America contribute to the English lexicon?

Answer: North America contributed thousands of words and phrases, beginning with borrowing from Native American languages for flora, fauna, and topography.

What are some examples of words introduced to the English lexicon in the 19th and 20th centuries?

Answer: Examples include words related to railroading, road infrastructure, and terms like bartender, patrolman, busboy, white-collar, boss, employee, department store, etc.

Give examples of vocabulary differences between British and American English.

Answer: Differences include fall (autumn), diaper (nappy), candy (sweets), bonnet (hood), holidays (vacation), flats (apartments), and the use of "gotten" (past participle of get).

Lesson-36

AMERICAN VS BRITISH ENGLISH: A COMPARISON

Topic 176: Difference Between Attitudes of Speakers

What are some factors discussed regarding the differences in attitudes of American and British English speakers?

Answer: Factors include history, the impact of colonization, geography, media, commerce, trade, and the inherent nature of people.

Topic 177: AmE and BrE: Phonological Differences

According to Fletcher (1990), what is General American in terms of pronunciation?

Answer: General American is the variety of accent spoken by the majority of Americans, with no noticeable eastern or southern accent.

Contrast the /r/ sound pronunciation in American English and Received Pronunciation (RP).

Answer: In American English, especially in the middle and western states, the 'r' is pronounced in all positions. In RP, the /r/ sound disappeared except before vowels.

What are some examples of words with different pronunciations between American English and British English?

Answer: Examples include figure /figjər/, leisure /li:ʒər/, vase /veiz/, and tomato /təmeiətu/, where the prevalent British pronunciations are currently in American English.

Topic 178: AmE (American English) and BrE (British English): Morphological Differences

According to George Bernard Shaw, how does morphology contribute to the difference between American English and British English?

Answer: Shaw's character states that the United States and the United Kingdom are 'two countries divided by a common language' due to morphological differences.

Give examples of morphological differences between American English and British English.

Answer: Differences include the directional suffix -ward(s) (e.g., forward vs. forwards), compound word formation (e.g., healthcare in AmE), and the absence of irregular past tense forms in AmE.

Topic 179: AmE and BrE: Lexical and Semantic Differences

What is a lexicon, and how does it contribute to differences between American English and British English?

Answer: A lexicon consists of different units of meaning or lexical items. Differences in words and phrases contribute to distinctions between American and British English.

Provide examples of words and phrases with different meanings in American English and British English.

Answer: Examples include bill (money vs. invoice) and biscuit (scone in BrE vs. cookie in AmE). Additionally, certain terms like 'copacetic' are less likely to be understood in American English.

Topic 180: AmE and BrE (Syntactic Differences)

How do collective nouns and sports team names typically behave grammatically in American English?

Answer: In American English, collective nouns and names referring to sports teams often require singular verbs.

Describe some syntactic differences between American English and British English.

Answer: Differences include the use of 'that' in restrictive relative clauses (more common in AmE), the preference for 'got' as a simple past tense in AmE, and variations in adverb use, such as 'real' in AmE compared to 'quite' in BrE.

Explain the differences in preposition usage between British English and American English.

Answer: Differences include "in a village" (BrE) vs. "on it" (AmE), "into/out of a car" (BrE) vs. "on/off a car" (AmE), and "at the weekend" (BrE) vs. "on the

weekend" (AmE). Additionally, there are variations in expressions like "please write to me soon" (BrE) vs. "please write me soon" (AmE).

Lesson-37

AUSTRALIAN ENGLISH

Topic 181: Australian English: Speakers and Demographics

What historical events contributed to the spread of English to Australia?

Answer: The expansion of the British Empire, with explorations by Portuguese and Dutch sailors, eventually led to British settlement in Australia.

Describe the origins of the name "Australia."

Answer: The name "Australia" is derived from Latin terra australis incognita, meaning 'unknown southern land.' It was chosen as a logical counterpart to the northern landmass of Europe and Asia.

When was the Commonwealth of Australia formed, and what is its significance?

Answer: The Commonwealth of Australia was formed in 1901, marking the combination of states. Australia Day, on January 26, 1788, commemorates the arrival of the First Fleet in Sydney Harbour.

Topic 182: Australia: The First Fleet

What were the circumstances of the arrival of the First Fleet in Australia in 1788?

Answer: The First Fleet, consisting of eleven British ships, arrived in Botany Bay in 1788. However, the fleet's captain, Arthur Phillip, found the site unsuitable, leading to the landing at Port Jackson (now Sydney Harbour). This event marked the beginning of white settlement in Australia.

What was the primary purpose of the First Fleet's arrival in Australia?

Answer: The majority of individuals on the First Fleet were convicts transported to the penal colony of New South Wales. Over the next 80 years, 160,000 convicts were sent to Australia.

Topic 183: What Becomes Australian English?

How has the demographic composition of Australia changed since the Gold Rush in 1851?

Answer: The discovery of gold in 1851 accelerated immigration, leading to a threefold increase in the settler population within ten years. This marked the end of convict transportation, and immigration patterns diversified, particularly after the Second World War.

When did Australia shift from being a British bastion to becoming a multicultural immigration country?

Answer: Since 1967, Australia began transitioning from a British stronghold to a multicultural immigration country, attracting people from South and East Europe, as well as more recently, Asians.

Topic 184: Australian English Today

How does the phonetician John Wells describe the uniformity of Australian English across vast distances?

Answer: Despite the large geographical spread, Australian English is remarkably uniform. Wells notes that accents from Perth to Sydney, covering over 3000 kilometers, are virtually indistinguishable.

What are some characteristics of Australian English vowels compared to RP (Received Pronunciation)?

Answer: In Australian English, vowel sounds differ, with differences in the diphthongs of words like "say" and "now." The characteristic sound of Australian speech is often found in its vowels.

Topic 185: Features of Australian English

How would you describe the vocabulary of Australian English?

Answer: The vocabulary tends to be colloquial and informal, with imaginative and colorful expressions. Examples include colloquial terms like "Aussie," "hoon," and abbreviations like "arvo" for afternoon and "tinnie" for a can of beer.

What is the significance of the Aboriginal loanword "kangaroo" in Australian English?

Answer: "Kangaroo" is the first Aboriginal loanword in English, recorded by Joseph Banks in 1770. It represents the indigenous people's term for a specific species of kangaroo, emphasizing the unique Australian fauna and flora.

How many Australian Aboriginal languages are estimated to be in active first-language use today?

Answer: About 50 Australian Aboriginal languages are in active first-language use, often in remote areas away from major population centers. However, there is a concern about the potential loss of many of these languages.

Lesson-38

SOUTH-ASIAN ENGLISH

Topic 186: Introduction to South-Asian English

What is the historical background of English in South Asia?

Answer: English was brought to South Asia in the early seventeenth century through British colonialism. It is currently spoken as a second language by approximately 33 million people, constituting 3% of the population across Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, the Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka.

What is the status of English in South Asian countries in various domains?

Answer: Even after years of independence, English is still used to varying degrees in government administration, law, the military, higher education, commerce, the media, and the arts across South Asian countries.

Topic 187: Features of South Asian English

How is South Asian English divided into varieties based on modern states?

Answer: The varieties of South Asian English are divided into Bangladeshi English, Indian English, Nepali English, Pakistani English, and Sri Lankan English.

Question: Provide examples of vocabulary specific to Indian English.

Answer: Indian English includes words from Indian vernaculars such as jungle, tank, bungalow, and also political and administrative terms like dharna, hartal, and swadeshi.

What are some differences in pronunciation and spelling in Indian English?

Answer: Unlike English, most Indian languages have nearly phonetic spelling. Pronunciations like /f/ for 'of' and [hauz] for 'house' (both noun and verb) are prevalent.

What are distinctive features of Pakistani English?

Answer: Pakistani English includes unique expressions like "in-charge," "same to same," and "got no lift." Specific terms like "Miss" for female teachers and "madam" for females in authority are common.

Topic 188: South Asian English: Imperialistic Legacy and Regional Asset

What are some historical languages of imperialism in South Asia?

Answer: Sanskrit and Persian are languages associated with historical imperialism in South Asia. Persian, particularly, played a significant role as the chief court language in successive Muslim kingdoms and empires.

How did Persian continue to influence South Asia even after imperial rule?

Answer: Persian continued as a major court language, and limited uses of Persian persisted in South Asia until the present time.

Topic 189: Syntax of South Asian English

What are some examples of sentences illustrating features of South Asian English syntax?

Answer: Examples include sentences like "Since her birth, she has been under the hands of men" and "Above half are conservatives," demonstrating certain idiosyncrasies in syntax.

How does South Asian English handle questions and reduplication?

Answer: South Asian English often forms information questions without changing the position of the subject and auxiliary items. Reduplication is observed, as seen in expressions like "hot hot coffee" and "small small things."

Topic 190: The Future of English in South-Asia

In what ways is South Asian English considered interesting and dynamic?

Answer: South Asian English is interesting due to its emergence as a distinctive form of communication, and dynamic because it constantly evolves to express nuances of South Asian cultures and sensibilities.

How is English viewed in South Asia in terms of identity?

Answer: English in South Asia has been nativized and is not considered a foreign language. It occupies a special position, contributing to creative writing, and South Asian writers are gaining international recognition, indicating that English is likely to persist in the region.

Sir Zahid

Lesson-39

ENGLISH LANGUAGE IN THE 21ST CENTURY: FEATURES OF ENGLISHES

Topic 191: The Regency of World English and the Future of English

What is the current status of English as a global language?

Answer: English is a global language with over 70 countries having special administrative status, and it is often a priority in foreign-language teaching policies. Over 100 countries treat English as a foreign language.

How has the number of United Nations member states influenced the role of English?

Answer: The increasing number of UN member states has led to a growing reliance on English as a "working language" due to the impracticality and cost of translation.

Topic 192: Number of English Speakers

What are the challenges in estimating the number of English speakers?

Answer: Estimating the number of English speakers involves challenges, particularly regarding the status of pidgins and creoles derived from English. The continuum of fluency further complicates estimates.

What is the significance of the figure mentioned by the British Council regarding English learners?

Answer: The British Council mentioned a billion people engaged in learning English, including all learners from beginners to advanced users. This figure is crucial in understanding the global influence of English.

Topic 193: Cross Linguistic Influence and the Spread of English

How has the historical development of English been influenced by contact with new environments and languages?

Answer: Throughout history, English has evolved due to contact with different environments and languages, resulting in the emergence of various English varieties.

What are some of the historical events that have significantly affected the development of the English language?

Answer: Events like the Roman Christianizing of Britain, Scandinavian invasions, Norman Conquest, Hundred Years' War, Renaissance, British Empire expansion, and growth of commerce and industry have impacted the development of the English language.

Topic 194: The Expanding Circle of English

How does Braj Kachru categorize English speakers into circles?

Answer: Braj Kachru categorizes English speakers into three circles: Inner Circle (first language), Outer Circle (second or semi-official language), and Expanding Circle (foreign language).

What is the significance of the 'Expanding Circle' in the context of English language use?

Answer: The 'Expanding Circle' represents areas where English is learned and used as a foreign language due to its usefulness for international contacts. This circle is continually expanding, strengthening English's claim as the international language.

Topic 195: Coming Full Circle: Emergence of World English

What factors have contributed to the dominance of English on the global stage?

Answer: The political and economic power of Britain in the nineteenth century and the United States in the twentieth century, along with the international spread of English, have made it the main language in publishing, science, technology, commerce, diplomacy, air-traffic control, and popular music.

What are the estimates regarding the number of English speakers worldwide?

Answer: There are over 300 million native speakers of English, with an additional 300 million regularly speaking it as a second language. Estimates suggest that around a billion people use English with varying degrees of proficiency.

How is the emergence of World English different from Latin's historical trajectory?

Answer: While Latin became a dead language, English is thriving globally. The reasons for English's emergence as World English include political, technological, economic, and cultural power.

Do you think English will follow the fate of Latin and become mutually incomprehensible English languages?

Answer: It is not likely; English is becoming a group of World Englishes due to global influence and interconnectedness, and mutual incomprehensibility is not a foreseeable outcome.

Lesson-40

FUTURE OF ENGLISH

Topic 196: Social and Political Power Associated with English

Why has English spread globally, considering it is not intrinsically simpler than other languages?

Answer: English's global spread is attributed to the power of the people who speak it. This power includes political, cultural, technological, and economic influences at different historical periods.

How did political power contribute to the spread of English?

Answer: Political power, exemplified by colonialism, led to English becoming a global language from the sixteenth century onwards, making it a language "on which the sun never sets."

Topic 197: Power of Knowledge and English Today

Why has English become the medium of a significant portion of the world's knowledge?

Answer: English is the medium of knowledge, particularly in areas like science and technology. The growth of English as the language of instruction in higher education worldwide has reinforced its role.

How has the Internet impacted the use of English in the modern era?

Answer: The Internet has played a revolutionary role in shaping language. English dominates online communication, with a significant portion of the world's everyday communication occurring in English.

Topic 198: Language Themes for the 21st Century

What linguistic challenges does the 21st century pose, particularly concerning the internet?

Answer: The 21st century presents challenges related to linguistic innovation and change, the internet's influence on language, evolving regional standards, and the emergence of 'New Englishes.'

How are communities responding to linguistic changes at an international level?

Answer: Communities, especially in international organizations like the European Union, are implementing strategies to safeguard language equivalence while recognizing the practical dominance of English.

Topic 199: Future of English

What trends are currently observable in the English language, and what might the future hold?

Answer: Current trends include vocabulary expansion, dialect-mixing, and potential changes in pronunciation and grammar. The future of English depends on global forces and community history.

How might reduced forms from electronic communication impact written usage in the future?

Answer: Reduced forms like those in text messaging might find their way into other written contexts, potentially leading to changes in language usage.

Topic 200: Factors that Will Determine the Future of English

What factors will determine the future of English?

Answer: The future of English is influenced by various factors, including the number of speakers, historical forces, and the interplay of centrifugal and centripetal forces shaping linguistic identity and comprehensibility.

How has globalization impacted language awareness and change?

Answer: Globalization, particularly through the media, provides immediate access to various English varieties, altering how people perceive and use the language.

How do centrifugal and centripetal forces operate in the context of English's future?

Answer: Both centrifugal forces, reflecting local identities and fostering diversity, and centripetal forces, promoting mutual comprehensibility and standardization, operate in the modern world. Both are essential for linguistic evolution.

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